

Date of Incident: 5/17/2026

Date of Report: 5/18/2026

Date of Resolution: 5/19/2026

Affected Systems: STAR Micronics Thermal Receipt Printer

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Report composed by: Jacob Wolford

Business Impact: Low (No data breach. Temporary disruption of service, small waste of physical assets (printer paper))

Summary

On 5/17/2026, a STAR Thermal Printer at [Business Redacted] printed unauthorized pages containing automated internet scan logs, raw command syntax, and a "I hacked you!" message.

As of current report, no data has been compromised as the business operates through [Internet Provider] and uses Square POS.

Most Likely Occurrence

Preliminary findings after research and talking with the owner suggest that the printer is using factory default settings (UN: root PW: public). The printer was most likely exposed to the web via an open port on the router, allowing either automated bots or a script kiddie to send raw text data to the printer's hardware. This perimeter firewall misconfiguration allowed an automated bot to send raw text directly to the hardware print buffer.

Technical Details and Evidence

Most Likely

The source of the exposure is the router or location of the printer. The router may have port forwarding enabled for TCP Port 9100 (RAW Printing). Otherwise, the printer was placed in the DMZ and was exposed to the internet.

IP/Host Involved

[Redacted]

Artifacts

Automated Web Scans were observed as the printer processed standard HTTP GET requests (GET /remote/login, GET /api/v2/about) originating from automated global scanners.

The commands were sent via Printer Job Language (PJL) as shown by queries (@PJL INFO STATUS (essentially “Do you have paper, are you on?”), @PJL RDYMSG DISPLAY = “rdymsgarg” (This tells the screen to print “rdymsgarg”))

The hack was perpetrated by t.me/CAMERAPW, a Telegram account that attacks IoT devices. This attacker printed “t.me/CAMERAPW HACKED YOU!”

Images of printed documents can be found at the end of the report.

Suggested Containment and Root Cause

The root cause is *most likely* a network misconfiguration rather than a targeted attack. This is probably the result of a bot running automated scripts on the internet. The RAW printing protocol requires no authentication, so the printer treated this hack as a valid job.

Containment and Resolution

1. Identify the internal IP address by powering off the device, hold the FEED button, and power it back on. This should print a configuration including the IP address.
2. Open a web browser and put in the Gateway IP address. Common addresses are []
3. Input the admin credentials. If not found on the router, the default may be searchable online.
4. Once inside the admin portal, navigate to the security or advanced network section. Find a tab named Port Forwarding, Port Triggering, Virtual Server, or Pinholes.
5. Scan the routing table for any rules mentioning Port 9100 or RAW/JetDirect. The rule will look like it is directing traffic from the internet to the Printer’s private LAN IP address.
6. Select the rule and click Delete, Remove, or Disable.
7. Apply Changes and Save.

DISABLING UPnP Instructions Follow

8. Inside the router’s admin panel, locate the LAN Settings, Advanced Network, or App and Gaming tab.
9. Find a setting called UPnP or Universal Plug and Play

10. Change the setting to Disabled or Off

11. Apply and Save.

TO VERIFY

12. Use a diagnostic app such as FING on a smartphone to run a port scan and see if 9100 is open.

ARTIFACTS

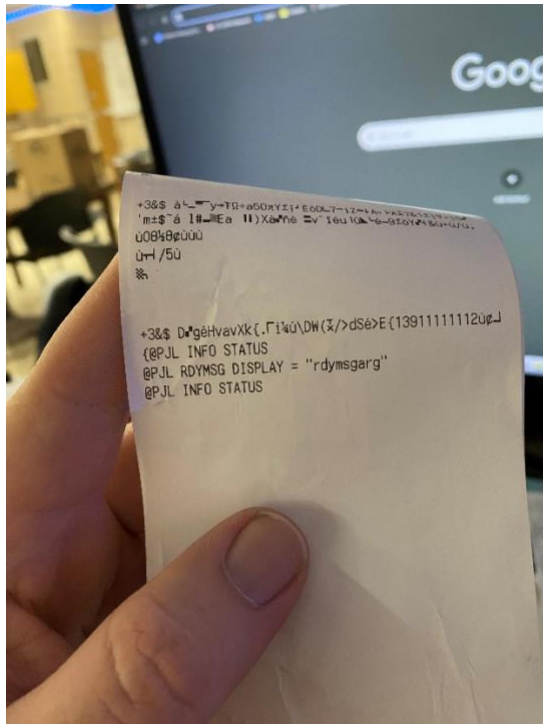
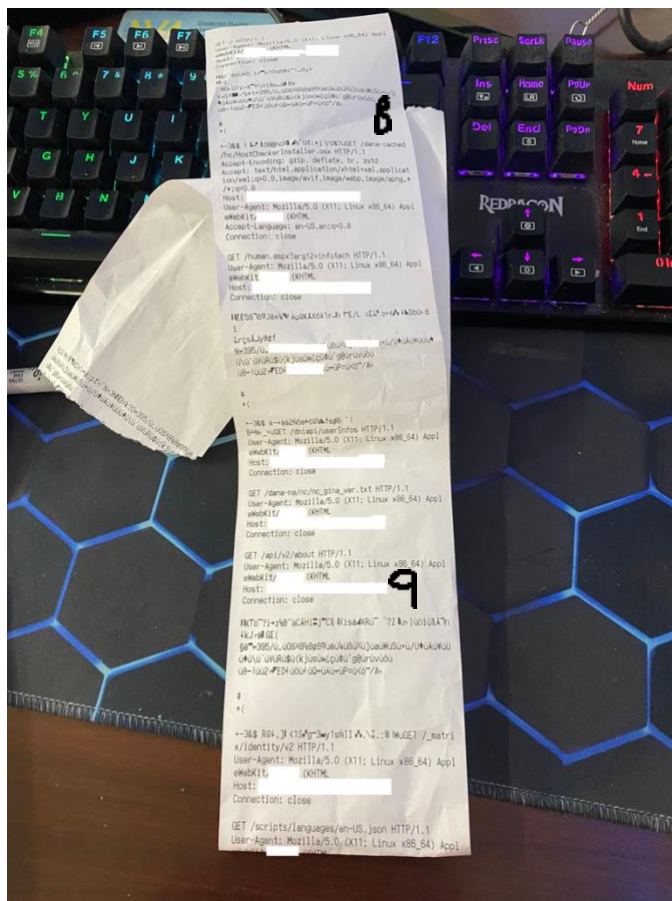


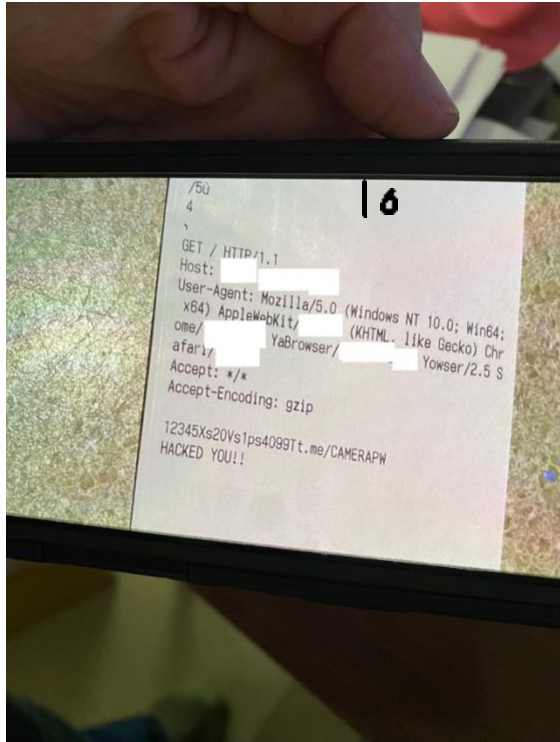
Figure 1 Printed receipt showing the P/JL commands



Figure 2 Bot Signature



8. The bot tries to use binary code injection but the printer didn't recognize it, so it spat out the symbolic equivalent of the binary. Then it switched to PJJ and hit paydirt. The printer responded with a system response to @PJL INFO STATUS
9. The rest of this is the bot cycling through common corporate gateways. These include VPN systems for government employees, Enterprise level File Transfer, and large network attached storage units to see if it can get admin creds straight from the device.



10. Here, the browser shifts from Mozilla based to YaBrowser, a popular Russian/Eastern European browser. The open Port 9100 allowed for a text injection.

Conclusion

An exposed Port 9100 allowed for unauthenticated text injection. The automated bot systematically cycled through its repository of enterprise and IoT exploits. Failing to find what it was looking for, it flooded the print queue buffer with raw text before closing the session.